Cultural Background Matters When Sharing Culturally Relevant Subject Matter

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Introduction

- Being aware of implicit biases helps avoid unjust outcomes for people of color (Thompson, 2019)
- Students work harder in courses where they perceive the instructor to be credible (Rezvani & Miri, 2021)
- White people in the United States tend to be more trusting when compared to people of color (Evangelist, 2022)
- Students perceive instructor credibility differently depending on the race of a professor (Hendrix, 1997)
- Increasing the perceived credibility of instructors may help in the delivery of diverse cultural curriculum
- This study seeks to examine if the cultural background of a speaker impacts their perceived credibility as well as if the participant race impacts this rating

Hypotheses

H1. The Native American speaker would be perceived as more credible than the Caucasian speaker

H2. White participants would perceive the speaker to be more credible than people of color (POC) would

H3. The Native American speaker would be perceived as more credible than the Caucasian speaker among POC than those who are Caucasian

Method

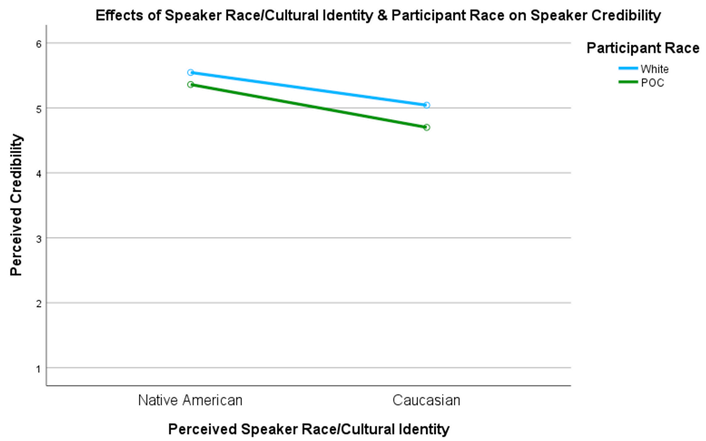
Procedure

- Participants were given a brief presentation regarding Kumeyaay history
- Participants either had a Caucasian presenter or a presenter that introduced themselves as Native American
- Participants were given a post-workshop survey measuring speaker credibility
- Once the surveys were collected, participants were debriefed and thanked for their help in the study

Results

Two-Way ANOVA

No interaction was found, $F(1, 86) = .10$, $p = .76$



Main Effects

- Participant race did not have a statistically significant impact on credibility ($p = .30$)
- Speaker identity impacted credibility ratings ($p = .02$)

4.85
Caucasian Speaker Mean Score

5.42
Native American Speaker Mean Score

Participants were asked to rate the credibility of the speaker on a scale from 1 to 6. On average, the Caucasian speaker was rated as less credible ($M = 4.85$) than the Native American speaker ($M = 5.42$).

Participant Demographics

- 90 Palomar College Students
- Ages 18 to 44 ($M = 21.74$)
- Majority Hispanic/Latino: 55.6%

Variable	1.	2.	3.	*M*	*SD*
1. Speaker's Identity				1.60	.49
2. Participant's Race	.07			5.15	1.64
3. Perceived Credibility	-.25*	.03		5.08	1.13

*$p < .05$

Study Design

- 2 × 2 Factorial Design
- Independent Variable: Speaker's Perceived Cultural Identity
- Participant Variable: Participant Race (White or POC)
- Dependent Variable: Speaker Credibility Rating

Discussion

- **Conclusion:** The findings suggest that when presenting on culturally relevant subject matter, having a presenter whose background reflects the presentation topic may be beneficial to student success and learning
- **Limitation:** Due to a shift in the composition of our research team, one member had to fill in the role of the Native American speaker despite not actually being Native American
- **Directions for Future Research:** Future studies should test these effects with an actual Native American speaker. Additionally, studies can test this effect with different presenter backgrounds and presentation topics.

References

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